memorable one-day international ever played.

Australia bat first and set what seems an unassailable target. Ricky Ponting thrashes 164 in 105 balls, including nine sixes. The tourists post a mammoth 434 for four in 50 overs. That should be that.

It isn't. To the amazement of an increasingly thrilled Wanderers crowd, Herschelle Gibbs leads the charge, batting at his brilliant best and cracking 175 runs from 111 balls. Wickets keep falling but the 'impossible' chase continues and, amid amazing scenes, Mark Boucher leads us to victory with one ball left and one wicket remaining.

The Test series that follows is almost an anticlimax, as the Australians prove too strong, winning comfortably in the Cape, and then in Durban, and finally in Johannesburg. We are humbled, whitewashed 0–3 at home, but there are no excuses. The touring side dominates. Sometimes you just say: 'Well done.'

But there's no time to rest.

As the Aussies fly home, the New Zealand team arrives and, within days, we are fighting hard on an up-and-down wicket at SuperSport Park in Centurion. It's a tight match and, dropped down the order to bat at No. 6, I fight hard and manage to score 97, the top score in our second innings. We are grafting.

'Who wants to watch Robbie Williams at Loftus tonight?'

It's an unusual offer in the middle of a Test but I love my music and, with a few others, accept the offer to attend the concert. The following day, we dismiss the Kiwis for 120 and win the Test.

There's a great vibe in the changing room after the match. These are special moments, when you sit with your teammates – and generally the opposition as well – celebrating a tough win with a few beers. Amid all the travel and the pressure, all the time spent away from home, these are the good times.

Jacques Kallis and Shaun Pollock have reached the milestone of their 100th Tests in the same match. Polly looks happy. He's talented,